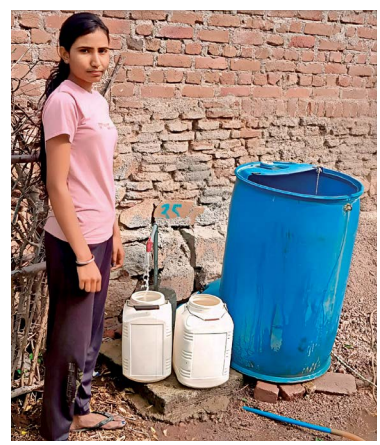
HAR GHAR NAL SE JAL
Launched in 2019

Achievement: From 18% in 2019, 80% rural households now have a tap connection

HOW IT TRANSFORMED MY LIFE

"I now have time to study"

Wise beyond her years, Class 9 student Akanksha remembers well how new daughters-in-law in their village would promptly be sent off to fetch water from faraway wells and hand pumps. The smallest district in Madhya Pradesh, abutting Uttar Pradesh, is part of the parched Bundelkhand landscape, where water scarcity was endemic. "Not only our village, the entire district had a water issue," says Akanksha. "We had to get water from a handpump far away. Time would be wasted and I would get late for school." Low water levels affected the farmers' ginger and turmeric crop, adding to their hardships.



AKANKSHA AHIRWAR, 14
Student, Babai, Niwari, MP

Jal Jeevan Mission changed all that. "Now we have water coming to our taps," adds Akanksha. Women are finding time for other work. Akanksha herself now has more time to study. "The entire village has become green," she says. The travails of the past are forgotten as all 55,645 houses in the district have water coming from their taps every day. ■

–Himanshu Shekhar